World Health Organization
African Region

Country-led evaluation and management response

Paper MEC-09, policy P5 of 7, for decision

Friday 20 November 2026, Session 3, 10:45–11:45 | Block C. Evaluation, accountability and planning | For decision

Draft of 4 November 2026 for TWG review. Parameters such as deadlines, response times and thresholds not set by the Framework are proposals, shown as such in the decision options.

The policy in brief

Each Country Office keeps a costed evaluation plan, commissions at least one substantive evaluation per biennium from non-earmarked funds, leads CCS evaluations with national evaluators, and answers every evaluation with a management response tracked to completion.

Why this policy

Monitoring shows what is happening; evaluation explains why, and tests the assumptions on which programmes rest. The Framework treats evaluation as a managed function whose value lies in the management response: findings must change planning and resources rather than rest on a shelf.

Country-led evaluation also serves WHO's accountability to Member States and its mandate to build national capacity: evaluations of the Country Cooperation Strategy belong to both WHO and the government.

What the evidence shows

- CCS evaluations are commissioned case by case and no regional roster of national evaluators exists (TWG review, 2026).
- The Framework names "an evaluation completed but its recommendations ignored" as a form of symbolic compliance (Annex C, Section C6); responses are not tracked in a common registry today.

Scope

The 47 Country Offices; the MSC Unit for the roster, quality assurance and the evaluation registry.

The policy

1. **An evaluation plan.** Each office keeps a costed evaluation plan for the biennium, set by risk and priority (Annex A, 6.1), recorded in the evaluation registry (Annex G, Module 9; until the module is in place, MSC keeps an interim registry) and included in its development plan and workplan.
2. **One self-commissioned evaluation per biennium.** From the 2028–2029 biennium, each office commissions at least one substantive evaluation per biennium on a question it chooses, financed from non-earmarked funds within its MEAL allocation (Annex A, 3.2; see P3). Strategic studies come in addition. Evaluations already planned for 2026–2027 continue under the plan recorded in 2027.
3. **Country-led CCS evaluations.** From 1 July 2027, CCS evaluations are led jointly with the national authorities and conducted by national evaluators drawn from a pre-qualified regional roster, with quality assurance by the Regional Office. The DPM approves any exception.
4. **A regional roster.** MSC establishes the roster by 30 June 2027 through an open call, with criteria for competence and independence, and renews it every two years.
5. **Credible standards.** Evaluations follow the norms and standards of WHO's evaluation function, with appropriate independence (Annex A, 6.2).
6. **A management response within 60 days.** The WR signs a management response within 60 days of the final report, stating for each recommendation whether it is accepted, and the action, owner and deadline.

7. **Tracked to completion.** Management-response actions are entered in the action tracker and verified like any other decision (see P6). Their status is reviewed in the monthly WR-led review and reported to the MEC each year.

Who does what

WHO Representative	Commissions evaluations, co-leads CCS evaluations with the government and signs the management response.
MEAL focal point	Keeps the plan and the registry entries; tracks management-response actions.
Programme leads	Carry out the actions accepted in management responses.
National authorities	Co-lead CCS evaluations and take part in the response.
MSC Unit and DPM	MSC runs the roster, quality assurance and the registry and reports to the MEC; the DPM approves exceptions.

Timeline

When	Milestone
31 Mar 2027	Templates for the evaluation plan and management response issued; interim registry opened by MSC
30 Jun 2027	Evaluation plans for 2027 recorded; regional roster established
1 Jul 2027	Country-led rule applies to new CCS evaluations
2027 planning cycle	Costed 2028–2029 evaluation plans in the workplans
MEC 2027	First report on evaluations and management responses

How compliance is measured

Indicator	Baseline	Target
Country Offices with a costed evaluation plan in the registry	Not yet measured	47 by 30 June 2027
Evaluations with a management response within 60 days	Not yet measured	100%
Management-response actions completed by their deadline	Not yet measured	At least 80%
CCS evaluations conducted by national evaluators from the roster	No roster	All new CCS evaluations from July 2027

Decision options

Option	What the MEC would adopt	Implications
A Recommended	**Plan and management response mandatory; roster mandatory for CCS evaluations, exceptions approved by the DPM**	Builds national evaluation capacity and a common standard; MSC must run the roster and quality assurance.
B	Plan and management response mandatory; roster recommended, not required	More flexibility for offices; CCS evaluations stay uneven in approach and quality.
C	Plan and management response only; CCS provision referred back to MEC 2027	Smallest step; postpones country-led evaluation by a year.

Resources

One self-commissioned evaluation per office per biennium, funded within P3; MSC time for the roster and quality assurance.

The MEC is asked to

Adopt the evaluation and management-response requirements, with the roster mandatory for CCS evaluations (option A).

Framework references: Framework Parts II.4 and X.2; Annex A, Sub-dimensions 3.2, 6.1 to 6.4, 10.1 and 11.4; Annex C, Domain 6 and Section C6; Annex G, Module 9. Domains: D6 Evaluation; D3 (Sub-dimension 3.2); D10 Accountability.